

AVENGERS

Earth's mightiest heroes

AVENGERS

FACTFILE

KEY MEMBERS

(see individual entries for powers)

THOR; IRON MAN;

ANT-MAN I (DR. HANK PYM AKA

GIANT-MAN, GOLIATH,

YELLOWJACKET);

WASP; HULK;

CAPTAIN AMERICA;

WONDER MAN; HAWKEYE;

VISION; SCARLET WITCH;

QUICKSILVER;

BLACK PANTHER;

BLACK WIDOW;

HERCULES; BLACK KNIGHT;

SHE-HULK; PULSAR (Monica

Rambeau aka Captain Marvel,

Photon); QUASAR; CRYSTAL;

SERSE; ANT-MAN II (Scott Lang).

BASE

Stark Tower, Manhattan; formerly Avengers Mansion (aka Avengers Embassy) Manhattan, and Avengers Compound, Palos Verdes, California

FIRST APPEARANCE

Avengers #1

(September 1963)

ALLIES/FOES

ALLIES Rick Jones, Edwin Jarvis, the Fantastic Four.

FOES Space Phantom, the Lava Men, the Mole Man, Baron Zemo, his Masters of Evil, Kang, Ultron, Collector, Grandmaster, Electro, Sauron, Madame Hydra.

ISSUE #1

Written by Stan Lee, penciled by Jack Kirby and inked by Dick Ayers, the first issue of *The Avengers* guest-starred Rick Jones, the Teen Brigade and the Fantastic Four.



The Avengers are dedicated to safeguarding the planet from super-menaces too powerful for a single hero or the armed forces of any one country to combat. Formed shortly after the first public appearance of the FANTASTIC FOUR, the Avengers immediately won government approval from the National Security Council of the United States and the General Assembly of the United Nations. Unlike the FF, the Avengers' roster is always changing. Members join, leave and return—a precedent set by the HULK, who left the team weeks after it was first formed.



Captain America had lain frozen in the Arctic ice since the end of World War II. Decades later, he was discovered and revived by the Avengers.

HERO TEAM

The Avengers were formed by accident. LOKI, Asgardian God of Evil, wanted revenge on his half-brother THOR. After searching for a menace powerful enough to challenge Thor, he selected the Hulk and tricked him into causing a train wreck. When the Hulk's former partner Rick JONES heard this news, he attempted to alert the Fantastic Four, but Loki diverted his radio signal and sent it to Thor. But the thunder god wasn't the only one to answer the call. The astonishing Ant-Man (see PYM, DR. HENRY), the WASP and IRON MAN also responded. While the other heroes battled the Hulk, Thor tracked down Loki and captured him. After learning that the Hulk was innocent, Ant-Man suggested that the heroes form a team. The Wasp suggested they call themselves "something colorful and dramatic, like ...the Avengers."

AVENGERS MANSION

Tony Stark (Iron Man) donated his three-story townhouse to the team who renamed it Avengers Mansion and later significantly modified it to fit their needs. Stark also funded the new team and provided

THE AVENGERS (2004)

1 The Wasp 2 Hawkeye 3 Scarlet Witch
4 Captain America 5 The Vision 6 Iron Man



Loki tried to escape by casting a spell that made his body radioactive. However, the heroes soon trapped him within a lead-lined tank.

